lake, was captured and taken prisoner. 6 Kumaon lost 118 men, 113 were wounded and 172 taken prisoner. 4 Dogra, the battalion that had so valiantly jumped into the fray on arrival, lost one officer, 2 JCOs and 107 other ranks.

4 Sikh owed a lot to the Bravo Company commander, Major Harbans Singh, who quickly organized the survivors at Walong and marched them out along the western route. The battalion suffered 180 casualties, of which 82 were killed. On the east bank, there were hardly any survivors from Lieutenant Palta's ill-fated company. Naik Kuldeep Singh, the only known survivor of the High Plateau battle, was perhaps the only one who managed to negotiate the eastern track and make it to Tezu on 4 December.

Delta Company of 3/3 GR at Lachhman Ridge was wiped out to the last man, and Captain Bavadam was taken prisoner. This gallant officer later died in the POW camp. The orders to withdraw were never communicated to Major Chand on The Ladders. He sent Naib Subedar Dil Bahadur who was with the rear platoon back towards Walong to find out what was happening. When the JCO reported that the Walong area was crawling with Chinese troops, Chand refused to believe him. The JCO was asked to take some men with him and go back yet again. As it was getting dark by then, the rear platoon of Charlie Company managed to evade the Chinese and set off for the plains. Major Chand and his remaining two platoons fought on through the night of 16-17 November, before evacuating The Ladders in the morning. Chand fell into the Lohit from where he was fished out and captured by the Chinese further downstream.

The other two companies of 3/3 GR on the east bank and Battalion HQ were virtually unscathed and they set off down the eastern track towards Hayuliang. However, they were relentlessly hounded by the Chinese and suffered heavy casualties during the retreat. The Chinese captured quite a few Gorkhas including Lieutenant Colonel Yadav during the retreat.

Brigadier Rawlley and the brigade group withdrew safely to Hayuliang. On the morning of 17 November, Kaul, who was scouting around in a Mi-4 looking for survivors, spotted the commander's party and landed on the riverbed. Kaul offered to fly Rawlley out with him, but the commander refused, saying his place was with his men.

Around the same time, Palit in Army HQ in Delhi received a signal sent by Kaul, presumably written just before he took off from Tezpur to look for survivors in Walong. The DMO was to say later 'that he sounded so